Laptop refresh policy and requesting new hardware

Article KB0010097 | Owner: Desktop Support | Subcategory: General | Applies to: All Acme Global employees using company-issued laptops, Windows 11 23H2/24H2 devices (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 devices (MacBook Pro/Air), Remote and on-site staff

Summary

This article outlines Acme Global's laptop refresh policy, eligibility criteria, and the step-by-step process for employees to request a new device. It also provides Desktop Support agents with the procedures they must follow to validate requests, provision hardware, and close the ticket.

Symptoms

- Current laptop is approaching end-of-life (typically 3-4 years old)
- Hardware performance issues that impact productivity (e.g., frequent crashes, insufficient RAM/storage)
- Device is damaged beyond economical repair
- User receives a notification from Intune that the device is non-compliant with security baseline

Common causes

- Scheduled hardware refresh cycle (every 36 months)
- Failed hardware diagnostics requiring replacement
- Change in role that necessitates a higher-spec model
- Security compliance update that the existing hardware cannot meet

Overview of the Laptop Refresh Policy

Acme Global replaces employee laptops on a fixed 36-month cycle to maintain performance, security, and compatibility with corporate software. The refresh is managed by Desktop Support in conjunction with the Asset Management team. Employees receive an automated reminder via email and the Company Portal when their device reaches the 34-month mark, prompting them to initiate a refresh request. Approved requests result in a provisioned replacement device being shipped to the user's primary work location (or home address for remote staff) within 5-7 business days.

Self-Help Procedure: Requesting a New Laptop

Follow these steps to submit a refresh request through the self-service portal. The process takes less than five minutes and does not require opening a ticket unless you encounter an issue.

1. Log in to the IT self-service portal at https://it.acme.example using your Acme credentials.
2. Select **'Request New Hardware'** from the service catalogue.
3. Choose **'Laptop Refresh'** as the request type.
4. Confirm your current asset tag (found on the bottom of the laptop) or let the system auto-populate it from Intune.
5. Select the preferred laptop model from the list of approved devices (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840, or MacBook Pro/Air). If your role requires a higher-spec model, add a brief justification in the comments field.
6. Review the summary, then click **'Submit Request'**. You will receive a confirmation email with a request number (e.g., REQ-2025-08456).
7. Desktop Support will review the request against the refresh policy and approve it within one business day. Once approved, you will receive shipping details and an expected delivery date.

Service-Desk Agent Procedure: Processing a Laptop Refresh Request

Agents in the Desktop Support queue must validate the request, check eligibility, provision the device, and update the asset record. Use the following workflow to ensure consistency and meet the P3 Moderate target (24?h resolution).

1. Open the request ticket (or self-service request) and verify the employee's eligibility: device age >=?34?months, no pending disciplinary action, and manager approval if a higher-spec model is requested.
2. Check Intune for the current device's compliance status and retrieve the asset tag. If the tag is missing, ask the user to provide it.
3. Approve the request in the portal and change the ticket status to **'Approved - Awaiting Fulfillment'**.

4. Create a provisioning order in the Asset Management system: select the approved laptop model, attach the user's cost centre, and add any required peripherals (dock, mouse, keyboard) based on the user's role.
5. Notify the logistics team to ship the device to the user's registered address (office or home). Include a prepaid return label for the old laptop.
6. Once the shipment is confirmed, update the ticket with the tracking number and set the status to **'Awaiting User Confirmation'**.
7. After the user reports receipt, guide them through the self-enrollment steps: connect to ACME-Corp Wi-Fi, sign into Company Portal, and complete Intune enrollment. Verify BitLocker/FileVault encryption is active and that the recovery key is backed up in Intune.
8. Instruct the user to return the old laptop using the supplied label. Upon receipt, run a data-wipe script, update the asset status to **'Retired'**, and close the ticket with resolution **'Laptop refreshed - new device deployed'**.

Verification and Closure

After the new laptop is in use, Desktop Support should confirm that the device meets all security and configuration baselines before closing the request. This ensures compliance and reduces repeat incidents.

1. Run a Defender for Endpoint health check via the Intune device inventory to confirm the device is compliant and reporting.
2. Verify that the user's primary applications (Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, Company Portal) launch successfully and that data sync is functioning.
3. Confirm that the user can connect to VPN (GlobalProtect) and access internal resources without prompts for re-authentication.
4. Ask the user to perform a quick test: open a locally stored file, save it to OneDrive, and verify that the file appears in the cloud within a minute.
5. If all checks pass, close the ticket with a final comment summarizing the actions taken and invite the user to contact the IT Help Teams channel for any follow-up issues.

When to escalate

If a request cannot be fulfilled within the standard 24-hour window (e.g., required model is out of stock, or the user needs a higher-spec device that exceeds the refresh policy limits), the Desktop Support agent should escalate to the Desktop Support Team Lead. Include the request number, user details, justification for the exception, and any relevant screenshots from Intune or the asset system. The Lead will review with Finance/Approvals and either authorize an exception or suggest an alternative solution.

Keywords: laptop refresh, hardware request, new laptop, device replacement, end-of-life laptop, Intune enrollment, self-service portal, Desktop Support, asset tag, BitLocker, FileVater, VPN, GlobalProtect